

MHI • TradingView Footprint Absorption

Location first — everything else is noise. Written for Gary Leung. Mini Hang Seng (HKEX:MHI1!), 1-minute Premium Volume Footprint. Study notes — not a guarantee.

Principle (read first): Location is the first thing. Other is noise. Footprint only confirms absorption **at a pre-marked level**. No level → ignore footprint, volume spikes, FOMO, pretty candles. Mark the level before price arrives; the tape does not invent a trade by itself.

1. Order of operations

- 1. **Location** — pre-mark at most two walls / CBBC clusters / round numbers / ORH • ORL. These are the only places footprint is allowed to matter.
- 2. **Sweep → absorb → reclaim** — price must pierce the level (cause), stall with heavy prints / POC at the extreme without a new extreme, then reclaim and close back through the level.
- 3. **Entry** — buy/sell stop at the reclaim bar’s high/low only after the sequence completes. No sequence → no order.

ORH / ORL = Opening Range High / Low. His usual OR window: 09:15–09:45 HKT. Draw ORH/ORL after 09:45.

2. Chart setup — Premium Volume Footprint

- Symbol: **HKEX:MHI1!** • timeframe **1m**.
- Indicator: Premium **Volume Footprint**.
- Row size: **Manual 5 ticks/row** (or 10 if too noisy).
- Type: **Profile**.
- Values: **Delta**, then toggle **Buy & Sell** when reading aggressor balance.
- POC: **On**.
- Imbalance: **300%** • Stacked: **3**.
- Summary: **Volume / Delta / Delta%**.

Pre-open / post-OR markup: draw two battlefield levels (option wall, CBBC pile, round 00/50) inside ~200 pts of estimated open. After 09:45, lock ORH and ORL. Footprint outside these lines is decoration.

IB alone has no full footprint — use TV Premium for this read; IB for execution. TV buy/sell is an intrabar estimate, not true aggressor tape (see § 8).

3. Bullish spring absorb (step sequence)

- 1 SWEEP** Price trades **below** the pre-marked level (ORL / Put wall / bull CBBC pile / round). Bar or cluster prints **negative delta** into the flush — sellers are aggressive. This is cause, not entry.
- 2 ABSORB** Stall: POC / heavy volume sits at the low; **no new low** on the next prints. Aggressive selling meets passive buyers — delta stops making fresh lows even if volume is still large.
- 3 RECLAIM** Close back **above** the level. Prefer a **delta flip** (bar delta turns positive). **Delta% ≥ +30%** on the reclaim bar is helpful. Stacked buy imbalances (3+) are a bonus, not a requirement.
- 4 HOLD** Within **3–8 bars**: ≥ 3 closes above the level, **no new low** under the sweep extreme. If a new low prints, the absorb failed — cancel.
- 5 ENTRY** Buy stop at the reclaim bar’s high (or first hold-bar high). Stop under the sweep extreme ± 1 tick. Invalidation = break of that extreme after entry.

4. Bearish = mirror

Sweep **above** level (ORH / Call wall / bear CBBC / round) with positive delta into the spike → stall POC/heavy at the high, no new high → flip reclaim close below (delta flip negative; Delta% ≤ −30% helpful; stacked sell imbalances bonus) → 3–8 bars with ≥ 3 closes below, no new high → sell stop at reclaim bar’s low. Same distance and late-entry rules as the spring.

5. What is NOT absorption

Looks like absorb...	Why it is not	Action
Long wick, delta still deeply negative	Sellers still winning the bar; wick ≠ passive bid	Wait for delta flip / reclaim close
09:30 mid-range volume spike	Cash open noise; follow/fade ≈ coin flip	Ignore direction; only note if it hits a pre-mark
Reclaim already >40–60 pts late	Late tax — R:R broken	Skip; do not chase
Lonely 3:1 imbalance, no level	Imbalance without location is random	Ignore
Forced CBBC hedge still running	Issuer still one-way; not finished absorb	Do not fade 屠牛/屠熊 mid-run
Heartbeat / FOMO / pretty candle	Emotion ≠ signal	Reduce size or stand down

6. 10-second checklist

- ☐ Pre-marked level exists?
- ☐ Sweep through it (cause)?
- ☐ POC/heavy at extreme, no new extreme?

7. Common misses

- **No pre-marked level** — reading footprint as a hunting tool across empty chart space.

- Reclaim close + delta flip?
 - Delta% helpful ($\geq +30\%$ / $\leq -30\%$)?
 - 3–8 bars: ≥ 3 closes, no new extreme?
 - Entry $\leq 40\text{--}60$ pts from level?
 - Invalidation written?
 - Not mid 屠牛/屠熊?
 - Not 09:30 mid-range only?
- Any blank → no trade. Half-size only when all ten clear.

- **Footprint as direction tool** — delta green $\neq$ buy the open; it only confirms at location.
- **Fading 屠牛/屠熊** while issuer hedge is still one-sided — wait until pile clears + absorb.
- **Chasing the first spike** — first flush/spike is cause; entry is after reclaim hold.
- Treating stacked imbalance alone as A+ without sweep→absorb→reclaim.

8. Honest limit

TV buy/sell is an intrabar estimate, not true aggressor tape / exchange order-book reconstruction. Use it as a **filter** that upgrades a location-based spring/upthrust — not a holy grail. Interactive Brokers has no full footprint; do not invent one from Time & Sales alone. Same candle can look “absorbed” on a 5-tick row and mixed on 10-tick — stay consistent with one row size per session.

9. Tie to A+ and stats anchors

A+ = bias + sweep/cause + absorption + invalidation. Footprint speaks only to the absorption leg. Bias comes from pre-open walls / CBBC / round; cause is the sweep; invalidation is the sweep extreme. Without all four, it is not A+.

Anchor (prior study notes)	Use with footprint
Spring structure $\approx +0.17R$ (PF ~ 1.44) vs cash 15m TORB $\approx -0.08R$	Prefer wait-for-fail/absorb over chase-break; footprint confirms the fail at the wall
09:30 follow / fade $\approx$ coin	Footprint mid-range at cash open does not mint a trade
Location from pre-open walls / CBBC / rounds	Mark first; footprint second — never reverse the order

Study notes for Gary Leung • 2026-09-07 • MHI 1m TradingView Premium Volume Footprint • Location first — everything else is noise • Not a guarantee of edge or fill quality • Fonts: embedded Noto Sans TC TrueType.